



Figure 1: vnStat PHP frontend main page

from <http://www.sqweek.com>, as follows:

```
[root@sun src]# wget -c http://www.sqweek.com/sqweek/files/
vnstat_php_frontend-1.5.1.tar.gz
```

Extract the downloaded archive in a Web-accessible directory, e.g. `/var/www/html/`

```
[root@sun src]# tar xzf vnstat_php_frontend-1.5.1.tar.gz
[root@sun src]# mv vnstat_php_frontend-1.5.1 /var/www/html/
vnstat
```

Edit the `config.php` file and set the following parameters as per your set-up:

```
[root@sun src]# vi /var/www/html/vnstat/config.php
$language = 'en';
```

```
$iface_list = array('eth0', 'eth1');
$iface_title['eth0'] = "Public Interface";
$iface_title['eth1'] = "Local interface";
```

If you are using SELinux, restore the file(s) default SELinux security contexts by using the `restorecon` command:

```
[root@sun src]# restorecon -Rv /var/www/html/vnstat/
```

Make sure that the correct local time zone is set in `php.ini`. Edit `php.ini` and set `date.timezone = "Asia/Kolkata"`

```
[root@sun src]# vi /etc/php.ini
date.timezone = "Asia/Kolkata"
```

Now enable web service at boot

```
[root@sun src]# chkconfig --level 345 httpd on
```

Start the Web service `httpd` as follows:

```
[root@sun src]# service httpd start
```

You can access vnStat with the PHP frontend by pointing your browser to `http://ipaddress/vnstat`, i.e., `http://192.168.1.140/vnstat/`

Allow port 80 on the server from outside, add rule in iptables by executing below command:

```
[root@sun src]#/sbin/iptables -A INPUT -m state --state NEW
-p tcp --dport 80 -j ACCEPT
[root@sun src]# /etc/init.d/iptables save
[root@sun src]# /etc/init.d/iptables restart
```

To secure the vnStat PHP frontend with user authentication, add an entry in `httpd.conf` at the end as shown below:

```
<Directory /var/www/html/vnstat>
    AuthUserFile /var/www/vnstat-httpasswd
    AuthName "vnStat user"
    AuthType Basic
    require valid-user
</Directory>
```

After making changes in the `httpd.conf` file, restart the `httpd` service:

```
[root@sun src]# service httpd restart
```

Create file `/var/www/vnstat-httpasswd`

```
[root@sun src]# touch /var/www/vnstat-httpasswd
[root@sun src]# htpasswd -cm /var/www/vnstat-httpasswd
vnadmin
```

This will add the user, with Force SHA encryption of the password.

Now point your browser to `http://192.168.1.140/vnstat/`. It will ask for the user name and password. After entering both, you will be able to see the vnStat PHP frontend main page as shown in Figure 1.

You can get details like the summary, hourly, daily and monthly graphical reports of bandwidth usage for configured interfaces. **END** 

## References

- [1] <http://humdl.net/vnstat/>
- [2] <http://linuxaria.com/recensioni/monitorit-your-bandwidth-on-linux-with-vnstat->
- [3] <http://www.sqweek.com/sqweek/index.php>
- [4] <http://www.thegeekstuff.com/2011/11/vnstat-network-traffic-monitor/>

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